

Monthly Program Report: Ilorin Innovation Hub

Reporting Period: January 2026

Month Overview

In January, the Ilorin Innovation Hub commenced the 2026 program year with activities focused on strategic alignment, accelerator onboarding, and structured talent pipeline activation. A total of 188 participants engaged across physical and virtual sessions, marking a strong start to the year. Notably, the Hub achieved a milestone 50% female participation rate, significantly surpassing the 30% target. The month emphasized leadership clarity, venture execution readiness, women-focused community engagement, and formal program rollouts, setting a disciplined foundation for the year ahead.

Program Overview

Program Goal

January focused on institutionalizing IIH's 2026 execution framework through structured accelerator deployment, performance-governed incubation programs, quality recalibration in technical training, and large-scale MSME mobilization under DBN ETP 8.0. The month emphasized alignment, accountability, and milestone-based progression across all verticals. Collectively, these efforts transition IIH from activity-driven programming to outcome-oriented ecosystem execution.

Key Activities Conducted This Month:

- **AMA Session with Temi Kolawole:** To align the community with IIH's 2026 strategic priorities and drive shared ownership across the innovation ecosystem.
- **Accelerator Launch Weekend:** To onboard and align the selected startup cohort through a structured three-day engagement focused on venture diagnostics, strategic clarity, and execution readiness within the IIH Accelerator programme.
- **Brunch with Zumah:** To create a reflective space for women within the IIH community to engage in open dialogue on career growth, personal balance, leadership boundaries, and the role of community support in sustaining long-term impact.

Progress Against Schedule (Key Performance Indicators):

KPI	Target for [January]	Actual for [January]	Variance [January]	YTD Actual	Variance YTD
Ecosystem Development (CcHUB)	N/A*	1	N/A	1	N/A
Ecosystem Development (IIH)	1	1	0	1	0
Talent Training (Future Africa)	N/A*	1	N/A	1	N/A
% of Attendance at Virtual Event	33%	62%	+29%	65	N/A
% of Attendance at Physical Events	50%	100%	+50%	123	N/A
Women Participation	30%	50%	+20%	61	N/A

**Targets for Q1 2026 are currently being finalized with partners.*

Key Achievements by Program Managers

Co-Creation Hub (CcHUB)

Role & Focus

Ecosystem Development & Capacity Development for Ecosystem Actors

Key Achievements This Month:

Ecosystem Development:

- **AMA Session with Temi Kolawole:** Sixty-five community members participated in a strategic alignment session focused on IIH's 2026 roadmap. The dialogue clarified program priorities, participation pathways, and execution focus areas across ventures and talent development, while enabling direct leadership engagement. The session strengthened ecosystem alignment and collective ownership of the year's agenda.
- **Community Engagement Calendar (Q1 2026):** The CcHUB team shared its January–March 2026 community engagement calendar outlining thought leadership sessions, technical bootcamps, and sector-focused engagements. The IIH team reviewed the proposed schedule and provided alignment feedback to ensure sequencing, resource allocation, and thematic focus support the Hub's broader priorities.

Technical Training:

- **Animate Africa 3D Training:** Of the 279 learners initially enrolled, approximately 50 remain actively progressing under defined attendance and milestone thresholds. To uphold IIH's quality standards, the program timeline was extended to March 31, 2026, enabling strengthened participation tracking, capstone completion, and competency-based assessment prior to graduation.

Enterprise Support:

- **Pre-Incubation & Incubation Program Curriculum:** The 9 pre-incubation ventures and 5 incubation-stage startups began a structured three-month curriculum designed to move teams from validation to investment readiness through defined milestones and performance benchmarks. The program combines residency-based deep dives with virtual advisory sessions covering business modeling, market research, product iteration, leadership, financial structuring, sales strategy, and compliance. Each module includes clear submission requirements and review checkpoints to ensure disciplined execution and measurable venture maturity throughout the cycle.

Future Africa

Role & Focus

Talent Development, Acceleration & Demo Day

Key Achievements This Month:

Technical Training:

- **24-Month Learn2Earn Fellowship:** The fellowship is set to commence in February with 171 confirmed fellows following completion of the selection process. The program has been formally structured as a two-year pathway comprising one year of intensive, project-based technical training followed by one year of industry internship. The curriculum emphasizes peer-driven, hands-on development across multiple programming languages, full-stack engineering, and domain specialization tracks. Administrative onboarding, cohort configuration, and technical systems setup are currently in progress to support a structured and performance-monitored launch.

Enterprise Support:

- **Accelerator Launch Weekend:** The Accelerator formally commenced with a three-day onboarding intensive for 9 selected startups, *enee.io*, *Flowsoft*, *GAUGE*, *GoChargeAm*, *Insight Works*, *Movnn*, *Pod*, *PERWER*, and *SPCTA*, all operating across priority sectors aligned with IHS challenge areas. The engagement focused on strategic alignment, venture diagnostics, and execution planning through structured pitch reviews and advisory sessions. The weekend concluded with a broader ecosystem mixer that attracted over 100 participants. The cohort now transitions into the virtual execution phase.

Ilorin Innovation Hub (IIH)

Role & Focus

Grassroots Ecosystem Development & Engagement

Key Achievements This Month:

Ecosystem Development:

- **Brunch with Zumah:** Over 20 women participated in a dedicated safe-space dialogue focused on career growth, intentional balance, and leadership development within the IIH ecosystem. The session strengthened peer

connections and reinforced female leadership engagement. The session was complemented by follow-up one-on-one engagements to provide personalized mentorship and sustained support.

Enterprise Support:

- **Entrepreneurship Training Programme (DBN ETP 8.0):** IIH has been designated as the Kwara State implementation center for the 8th edition of the DBN Entrepreneurship Training Programme, with a mobilization target of 3,000 MSMEs. The program aims to strengthen business operations, financial management, and credit readiness through structured digital and in-person training, with the physical pitch session scheduled for June 2026.

Gender Registration & Attendance Metrics

- Overall Registration: 228
- Monthly Physical Program Attendance: 123
 - Male Attendees: 62
 - Female Attendees: 61
- Monthly Virtual Program Attendance: 65
- Overall Monthly Program Attendance (Virtual + Physical): 188
- Registration to Attendance Ratio: approximately 1:1

Upcoming Activities & Next Steps

Planned Activities for Next Month

- **IIH:** AI Conference 2026; Web Summit Qatar
- **CcHUB:** Builder's Path; Ilorin DevBox; Bootcamps; Animation Training
- **Future Africa:** Virtual transition of the Accelerator; commencement of the Learn2Earn Fellowship